

Thomas Cheesman

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I specify software precisely, direct AI to build it, and own everything that comes out the other end — the design calls, the evidence rules, and the mistakes. Seventeen years running kitchens taught the half that transfers: decide what good means, write the standard down, and hold every plate to it. Since 2023: three live sites in three deliberately different designs, and a research application mapping nearly four thousand official statistical reports and the documented dependencies between them. Looking for remote work in web development, digital operations, accessibility, or nonprofit technology.

SELECTED PROJECTS

The Economic Report Influence Graph

July 2026 – present

TypeScript · React · Three.js · no backend · github.com/DriftingSplash9/Reports-Clustering

- A browser-based 3D map of where official numbers come from: which published statistical report is calculated from which other, across 130+ countries and every tier from national to municipal.
- Built on one rule — *no document, no edge*. A dependency is drawn only where a published source says so in quotable words, and every edge carries an A/B/C grade for how well its citation supports it. Holding that standard across eighty-plus research sessions is the hard part, so the repository carries a fixed extraction protocol and a validator that refuses to pass on a dangling reference.

Bare Your Rare — rare-disease stories and resources

2024 – present

bareyourrare.org · founder, designer, writer

- A patient-led site for ultra-rare conditions — first-person stories, condition guides, registries and support — built because most people searching for one of these conditions find almost nothing. Written in plain language, structured to be legible to the AI tools newly diagnosed patients now reach for first.

Grande Prairie Residential Society website

2023 – present

gpresidentialsociety.com · designed, built and maintained solo

- Public site for a volunteer-run nonprofit providing barrier-free housing — 87 units before the Margaret Edgson Manor fire, with the rebuild under way. Housing applications, donations, fire and rebuild updates, and a newsletter. Accessibility and plain language are first-order requirements here, not decoration applied at the end.

Personal platform — family history, tools, and writing

2024 – present

thomascheesman.ca

- An eight-line family heritage archive with long-reads, privacy-first galleries, a timed game with a server leaderboard, and an interactive map plotting four centuries of documented events as certainty-weighted markers.

Rocket Lander

2026

Godot 4.7 · GDScript · Jolt physics

- A teaching game on a real aerodynamic flight model — gimballled thrust, split along-hull and across-hull drag, layered gusting wind, finite fuel. The 38 tuning knobs are the interface, so a child learns the forces by flying against them.

EXPERIENCE

Board Member — Grande Prairie Residential Society June 2023 – present

- Created and publish the public website. Volunteer on the maintenance, marketing and special projects committees, starting a fundraising committee, and contribute to outreach, planning and governance — including through the post-fire rebuild of Margaret Edgson Manor.

Caregiver — private client, Grande Prairie March – December 2023

- Round-the-clock care team for a palliative teenage client: schedules, diet, appointments, medications.

Executive Chef / Kitchen Manager — Majors Homestyle & Tractor Jack’s 2015 – March 2019
Grande Prairie · private ownership

- Ran daily operations, budgets, purchasing, staffing and HR for two rooms under one roof, plus banquets and catering — including a standing contract feeding the crews building the region’s new hospital. Consulted for the owner for about a year after leaving.

Head Chef — Ric’s Grill, then Township 71 2013 – 2015
Grande Prairie · franchise, then independent fine dining

- Head Chef at Ric’s Grill; wound it down to renovate and open Township 71, an independent fine-dining room, in November 2014 — straight into the oil-price crash. Closed it in May 2015. Across the career: opened one restaurant, closed two, in corporate, franchise and private settings.
- While running Ric’s, taught one semester of the culinary side of the Hospitality and Tourism diploma at GPRC (now Northwestern Polytechnic) — wrote the curriculum, lesson plans and practical assessments.

Kitchen Manager — The Keg Steakhouse & Bar 2002 – 2013
Grande Prairie · corporate

- Hired as a salad tender; worked up the line to assistant kitchen manager, then kitchen manager for roughly ten years through the oil boom, in the toughest labour market in the country. Met or beat budget, and ran the kitchen ranked best in the corporation for Alberta.
- Built the custom Excel systems the operation ran on — inventory, costing, sales, staffing and waste. Apprenticed cooks; set up the health and safety committee.

SKILLS, EDUCATION & TICKETS

Web	HTML, CSS, JavaScript, TypeScript, PHP, custom WordPress themes, accessible UI, Git and GitHub		
AI-assisted	Specify, review, debug and ship; prompt and protocol design; editorial control over generated code; holding one standard across long multi-session work		
Leadership	Kitchen management, apprenticing and teaching, nonprofit board work, disability advocacy		
Writing	Plain language for people who did not come for the jargon; patient-facing, nonprofit and technical docs		

Journeyman Chef	Red Seal · SAIT, 2012	B.Sc.	Credits earned, 1999–2002
Self-directed	freeCodeCamp and related; daily build practice on live sites	Also held	Power Engineering 4th Class · Gas Plant Operator Levels 1 and 2

CAREER NOTE

I left the line in 2019 because I have Hajdu-Cheney syndrome, a rare connective-tissue disorder, and kitchen work stopped being sustainable. A couple of surgeries and stay-at-home parenting followed. I started learning to program; when AI crashed that party I switched to understanding AI itself, then to shipping public sites. The work is remote, and that is the only thing I need it to be.